

Kalina Kazmierczak

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EDUCATION

Virginia Tech

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science; Human Computer Interaction Minor
Cum Laude

Blacksburg, VA

August 2021 - May 2025

WORK EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer 1

CoStar Group

Arlington, VA

July 2025 – Present

- Built an AI knowledge layer over composable ETL models, answering natural-language questions on model behavior, lineage, and dependencies with cited documentation; integrated Datadog, Snowflake, and scoped Azure Repos access.
- Integrated S3-backed data sources with vector stores to support semantic retrieval over internal documentation and model metadata.
- Designed and implemented RESTful APIs and data models for internal developer tools, balancing technical constraints with real user needs.
- Built reusable React component systems that balance flexibility with consistency across teams and products.

Undergraduate Research Assistant

Virginia Tech

Blacksburg, VA

Jan 2023 – May 2025

- **SeeMore Project:** Reverse-engineered and restored legacy kinetic sculpture system, migrating from non-functional 2014 Mac Mini installation to Raspberry Pi. Debugging hardware constraints and inventing solutions without documentation.
- **Hidden Figures in HPC:** Built JavaScript visualizations and contributed to Python/Flask backend, making complex technical achievements accessible and engaging to broader audiences.
- Selected as 1 of 5 students to present at SC23 International Conference (13,000+ attendees)—communicated technical work to diverse audiences.
- Mentored new contributors in open-source environment, establishing patterns for collaboration without rigid handoffs.

Software Engineer Intern

CoStar Group

Richmond, VA

June 2024 – August 2024

- Designed and shipped production dashboard for monitoring AWS CloudWatch SQS queues, now used daily by multiple teams for operations and incident response.
- Owned end-to-end product development: identified user needs, designed interface for information density and speed, and implemented with React and Highcharts.
- Built comprehensive filtering and customization features prioritizing keyboard-first interaction and minimal friction.
- Shipped iteratively in tight cycles, gathering feedback and refining based on real usage patterns.

PROJECTS

Mabawa Scratch Coding Workshop | Nyamyumba, Rwanda

- Designed curriculum making programming accessible to 3rd graders with no prior computer experience
- Invented teaching patterns that made abstract computational concepts intuitive through creative storytelling
- Recognized with Emily Specchio Foundation Scholarship for impact and approach

Bun Appétit (1st place VTURCS)

- Designed and built gamified food journaling app exploring novel interaction patterns for AI-powered photo recognition.
- Created custom AI prompts for character dialogue and integrated location-based features. Prototyping how AI agents communicate with users.
- Iterated rapidly on AI confidence scoring mechanics to balance accuracy with engaging gameplay.

SKILLS

- **Design & Prototyping:** Figma, UI/UX design, interaction design, rapid prototyping
- **Development:** JavaScript, React, Python, C#, C, HTML/CSS, Git, Linux
- **Developer Tools:** Terminal/CLI, AWS, SQL, VS Code
- **Approach:** Code-literate designer; comfortable prototyping in code, understanding technical constraints, and shipping iteratively